MODULE 00 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

AWS Certified DevOps Engineer – Professional

DOP-C02. How this course works, what the exam really tests, and how to get the most from the next nine hours.

DOMAIN All six EXAM WEIGHT 100% MODULE 0 of 34

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This exam rarely asks what a service **does**. It asks you to **choose** between options that all work, using one detail in the question.

The exam, in facts

ITEM	DETAIL
Questions	75: 65 scored, 10 unscored that you cannot identify
Time	180 minutes, about 2.4 minutes per question
Types	Multiple choice, and multiple response: choose two or three
Score	Scaled 100 to 1,000; 750 to pass; compensatory across domains
Guessing	No penalty: never leave a question blank

ON THE EXAM

Compensatory scoring means a weaker domain can be offset by stronger ones. Every question counts the same.

Six domains, and where they are taught

DOMAIN	WEIGHT	MODULES	WORKED SCENARIOS
1 SDLC Automation	22%	2 to 8	32
2 Configuration Management and IaC	17%	9 to 13	24
3 Resilient Cloud Solutions	15%	14 to 16	22
4 Monitoring and Logging	15%	17 to 20	24
5 Incident and Event Response	14%	21 to 23	20
6 Security and Compliance	17%	24 to 27	24

ON THE EXAM

Domain 1 is the largest, and its pipeline ideas return in every other domain.

The shape of the course

01

Module 1

The mental model: how one change flows through AWS.

02

Modules 2 to 27

The six domains, each with worked scenarios.

03

Modules 28 to 30

Exam skills: confusion pairs, question writing, what changed.

04

Modules 31 to 34

Four practice exams, 80 questions.

ON THE EXAM

Watch in order. Later modules assume vocabulary and patterns from earlier ones.

How every teaching module is built

PART	WHAT IT DOES
The mental model	One idea that organises everything in the module
Teaching slides	Services and features, with dates where they changed
Tiebreakers	The one question that separates two similar options
Worked scenarios	Exam-style questions, every option explained
Five-line summary	What to remember, in five sentences

ON THE EXAM

The tiebreakers are the most exam-relevant slides in the course. They reappear together in module 28.

How to use the worked scenarios

- When 'Pause and decide' appears, **pause the video** and commit to an answer.
- The walkthrough explains why the right answer wins, and why **each wrong option** fails.
- After a miss, ask: was it a **knowledge** error, or a **reading** error?
- Knowledge errors: rewatch the teaching slides. Reading errors: find the detail you missed.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Recognising the right answer is easy. Choosing it before you see it is the skill the exam tests.

The catalogue has moved

- The exam guide predates many changes. Retired services can still appear as options.
- Slides titled **The catalogue has moved** flag each change where it comes up, with its date.
- On the exam, answer in the **guide's terms**. At work, use today's services.
- Module 30 lists every change in one place.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Verified against AWS documentation, September 2026. Check retirement dates the week you sit the exam.

The practice exams

FEATURE	DETAIL
Papers	Four, of 20 questions each, all new
Weighting	Across all 80 questions, matching the domain weights
Multiple response	17 questions, about the real exam's rate
After each question	A pause, then a full worked solution
Scoring	By domain, with the module to revisit for each miss

ON THE EXAM

Score each paper by domain, not only in total. A domain weak on two papers is your priority.

A study plan that works

- Two or three modules a day completes the teaching in about two weeks.
- Take practice exam 1 after module 30, and score it by domain.
- Revisit weak domains, then take the next paper. Leave days between papers.
- The night before: rewatch Confusion Pairs and The Revision Gap.

> ON THE EXAM
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> If you score 16 out of 20 or more consistently, you are ready to book.

Before you start

- The exam is aimed at engineers with hands-on experience operating AWS.
- You should already know core services such as EC2, S3, IAM and VPC at associate level.
- No lab account is required, but trying features yourself makes them stick.
- This course is not affiliated with or endorsed by Amazon Web Services.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Where AWS documentation is unclear, or has moved on since the guide, the course says so.

Module 0 in five lines

- The exam tests decisions between working options, decided by one planted detail.
- Six domains, taught in modules 2 to 27, with 160 worked scenarios.
- Pause at every scenario; name each miss as knowledge or reading.
- Answer in the guide's terms; module 30 tracks what has changed.
- Four practice exams at the end. Score by domain; book at 16 or more.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Next, module 1: how a release flows through AWS, the mental model for everything that follows.